

JACQUI LOUGH

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PROFILE

A career spanning journalism, software engineering and computational storytelling, with senior roles at The New York Times, BBC News Labs, Condé Nast International and News Catalyst. Combines editorial judgment with technical depth to turn complex information into accessible, public-interest stories, with experience across data analysis, visualisation, automation and interactive experiences. Currently studying public health, with a focus on epidemiology and evidence-based communication, which has sharpened an interest in population-level data and how to report on it clearly.

SKILLS

- **Data Journalism & Analysis:** Data analysis, wrangling, interpretation and reporting. Design of automated workflows, scrapers, custom APIs and data pipelines.
- **Interactive Journalism & Visualisation:** Creating interactive data visualisations, digital storytelling and audience-facing products with D3.js and modern frontend frameworks including React, Next.js and Vue.
- **Software Engineering & Infrastructure:** Full-stack engineering in Python, Go, Ruby and JavaScript/TypeScript. Advanced database design across PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch and MongoDB. Hands-on DevOps, AWS and Linux/Unix systems administration.
- **Newsroom Leadership & Public-Interest Tech:** Editorial technology strategy and product development. Leading cross-disciplinary newsroom teams. Proven experience building open-source health and publishing infrastructure internationally, including field implementation in Malawi and South Africa.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Developer

2020 – 2022

News Catalyst, Temple University | Remote

- Built affordable, high-impact publishing and workflow tools that enabled small newsrooms to produce richer digital journalism.
- Designed and maintained production systems including cloud infrastructure, APIs, integrations and publishing workflows.
- Developed custom applications and newsroom tools using web technologies, mainly JavaScript, and Google Workspace integrations.
- Worked directly with journalists and editors to translate editorial challenges into practical technical solutions.

Head of Interactive Journalism

2016 – 2018

Condé Nast International | London, UK

- Built and led a global interactive journalism team supporting international Vogue brands, recruiting and coordinating editorial, design and engineering talent across markets.
- Developed experimental journalism products and editorial tools, including the first fashion industry messaging chatbot for British Vogue.
- Partnered with international teams to explore structured fashion data and new models for content distribution, bridging editorial goals with technical implementation.

Interactive Journalist

2015 – 2016

BBC News Labs | London, UK

- Produced a high-impact, multilingual interactive graphic novel exploring the drug trade in Guinea-Bissau, localised across multiple languages including Arabic.
- Engineered an automated election graphics pipeline featured by BBC Visuals and News Labs to scale real-time broadcast data for digital platforms.
- Pioneered experimental publishing formats and systems, including for audiences accessing news within low-bandwidth or challenging information environments.

Assistant Editor, Interactive News

2009 – 2014

The New York Times | New York, USA

- Promoted from News Applications Developer to Assistant Editor on the Interactive News desk.
- Developed and edited award-winning interactive journalism projects combining reporting, data analysis, design and technology, including *Coming Out*, an Emmy-nominated interactive documentary, and data-driven interactive coverage of the *London 2012 Olympics*.
- Built editorial applications, data systems and publishing tools to collect, analyse and publish complex information, including a data integration system supporting humanitarian information exchange for the Haiti earthquake missing persons project.
- Contributed to early newsroom analytics initiatives and data-informed editorial practices.

Public Health Developer

2004 – 2006

Baobab Health Partnership | Lilongwe, Malawi

- Worked on health information systems supporting HIV/AIDS treatment programs in Malawi.
- Contributed to the development of the Baobab Anti-Retroviral Treatment (BART) system used in clinical settings.
- Collaborated with health professionals to improve data collection and patient management systems.

Full career history available upon request.

EDUCATION

Public Health & Data Studies

Swinburne University & University of South Australia | 2024 – Present

Academic focus on epidemiology, population health data, infectious disease and evidence-based scientific communication.

EXTRA

- **Awards:** News and Documentary Emmy Nomination, for *Coming Out* (The New York Times).
- **Speaking:** Frequent invited speaker at international journalism and data conferences, including NICAR, the International Journalism Festival (Perugia), H/H Media Party (Buenos Aires), Hacks/Hackers meetups across the US and Europe, and the Reuters Institute at Oxford University.
- **Judging:** Judge, Online Journalism Awards (multiple years).

REFERENCE

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Former editor, Interactive News, The New York Times — Former director, News Catalyst